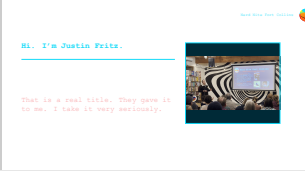



**TITLE** 0:00

- Title. Then stop. Let it sit.
- Do NOT flip it yet — that is slide 7.

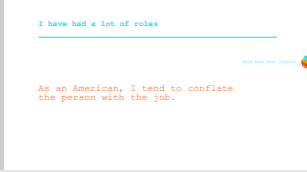
*The tagline is already the close, on the wall, ten minutes early. Nobody needs to notice.*




**WHO IS TALKING** slides 2–5 share 2:30

- "Hi. I'm Justin Fritz. And I'm a Nerd Nite Boss."
- "That's a real title. They gave it to me. I take it very seriously."
- Fast and warm. Do not linger.

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**THE ROLES**

- Marine. Navigator. Instructor. Chip designer. Founder. Host.
- "As an American, I tend to conflate the person with the job." ← **the laugh**
- "Tonight I am here as myself. And as a Nerd Nite boss." — land it straight.

**Past tense on the Marines.** It is one item in a list that exists to be undercut. Not a credential, not the opening.




**THE RELEVANT EDUCATION**

- "Not the classrooms."
- "In the field. In the lab. Frankly — at Nerd Nites."
- Gesture at the collage. Name one or two, no more: the flight line, the summit.

Do not inventory the career. Slide 3 already did it.

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**TRAJECTORIES** — end of the introduction

- "Everything I just listed is a sampling of one trajectory."
- "Everyone in this room has a rich history."
- "Tonight ours came together here."
- **"Thank you." ← STOP. Let it land.**

Grateful to all who share, all who facilitate, all who come. Rushing this costs the rest of the talk.




**WHAT THIS COVERS** 0:45

- “Talks. Mars. An abstract. An organ.”
- Fast. Do not expand any of them.

It is meant to make sense in retrospect, not now.

**THE FLIP** 1:30

- "You had to be there" is what people say when the telling failed.
- The story died on the way over. It is an apology.
- Tonight it is not an apology. It is the condition of the room.

**NEEDS FROM YOU:** the opening twenty seconds — one time the phrase failed on you. Still open.




**HANNAH** 2:30

- *Worst Party Ever.* Hannah Bauer. Jan 2025.
- "Most people hear Donner Party and think cannibalism. Valid — but that only scratches the surface."
- She put the room inside their heads. And we laughed. About the Donner Party.
- "Nobody at Wolverine Farm was in the Sierra Nevada in 1846. For a moment they were."

**Wolverine Farm, never "a bar."** Do not explain why it matters — that is Mars.

**BERLIOZ** 0:30

- Read the title aloud. Stop. Add nothing.
- Matt Browne, April 2024.

**FIRST CUT IF RUNNING LONG.**

**THE HINGE** 0:45

- "You weren't at any of those."
- "Berlioz has been dead since 1869 — the speaker wasn't there either."
- "Three minutes of second-hand material. And it worked."
- **"So why did that just work?"**

**ASK IT. DO NOT ANSWER IT.** Pause, then move. Answer it here and Mars goes flat for two minutes.




**MARS**

- “We have never sent people. We sent probes, rovers, instruments.”
- “They returned more data than anyone can read.”
- “Somebody had a hypothesis before it ever launched.”
- “Somebody else is reading it back.”
- Neither is in the data stream.

Do not rush. This is the only abstract beat and it buys the next two.

**THE LINE**

- "The telemetry is complete. The chronicle is not."
- "It is where the people are that the cognition happens."

Once. Flat. Do not elaborate. Next beat.

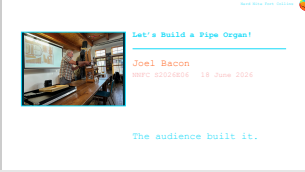



**JOHN** 1:30

- *Worm Majix.* John Anderson. Sep 2025.
- Long-time friend of Wolverine Farm. Watched the crowd assemble. Asked Senne. Got a slot.
- "The abstract came in rough. Jamie started fixing it. I stopped her."
- "We platform people who want to talk. Connect speakers and audience — don't filter them."
- He gave it as himself, dressed how he dresses. Great talk.

**DO NOT READ HIS ABSTRACT ALOUD.** That makes John the joke in front of other bosses.

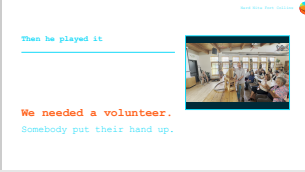
*Optional, one sentence, your call: same mechanism as the HoloLens spec bug — a legible restatement silently becomes the reference.*




**THE BUILD**

- *Let's Build a Pipe Organ!* Joel Bacon. June 2026.
- He talked through the parts — wind supply, keys, pipes.
- "Hundreds of parts. Two octaves, hand pumped, mechanical action."
- **"And the audience built it."**

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**THE LANDING** the only real feeling in the talk

- "Then he played it." Professor, composer, working musician.
- **"It connected me to the music in a way I had never felt before."**
- ← **ONE SENTENCE. THEN STOP.** The pause does the work.
- "A hand-pumped organ cannot make a sound unless somebody is standing there supplying the air."
- "We needed a volunteer. Somebody put their hand up."

**NO second sentence. NO "and that's what Nerd Nite does."** Say **a volunteer**, not "an audience member."

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**THE CLOSE** 0:30 screen is empty

illness.

- **"You had to be there."**
- **"You are."**

**NOTHING AFTER IT.** No thank-you (that was slide 5). No call to action. Stop talking.

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**CREDITS** — questions only

- Advance here when the first question comes. Leave it up throughout.
- Do NOT show it during the talk.

If Berlioz got cut for time, Matt Browne stays on this slide anyway.